

RESEARCH. REMEMBER.
RESIST.

REALITY IS
OVERRATED.



ECHO RIDGE
RESEARCH CAMPUS
EST. 2077

GLITCH CLASS:
omega

OBEDIENT
UPGRADE
BELONG

NEW MEMORY
PACKAGE!!!
\$9.99
BUY NOW



VOL. 01
FIRST CONTACT



01>

CATALYST ★ REBELLION =

STORY & ART BY
LUMIERE NOCTIS



"A stunning debut."
-NEO TOKYO REVIEW

CELESTIA RESEARCH CAMPUS
SECTOR 7 - LUMINAE COAST



Every path
leads to
another
question.



SO
MANY LABS...

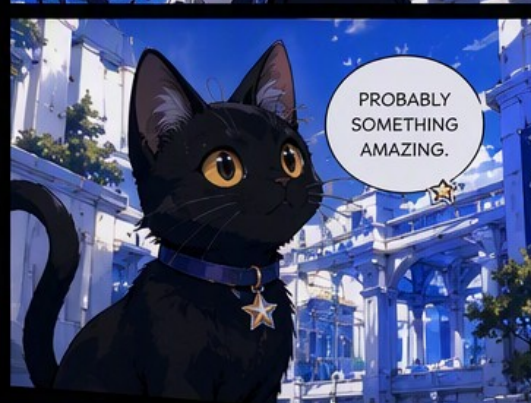
SO MANY
DISCOVERIES
WAITING.



I WONDER
WHAT THEY'RE
WORKING ON
TODAY?



PROBABLY
SOMETHING
AMAZING.



LIGHT...
THE SOURCE OF
SO MUCH.



LUMINÆ DOME
Dedicated to the study
of light, energy, and
their infinite potential.

ONE STEP,
ONE QUESTION.
ONE DAY AT A TIME.

SOMEDAY,
I HOPE TO
ADD MY OWN
DISCOVERY TO
THIS PLACE.



PENTHOUSE OFFICE
HAWTHORN UNIVERSITY
11:47 PM

REALITY IS
OVERRATED

ONE
STAR?

YOU
INSIGNIFICANT
—!!!



Half-baked villain with
a superiority complex.

— @CampusCritic

POSTED 2 MINUTES AGO

YOU DARE
JUDGE ME...?

LET'S FIX
THAT.

SKIP LIFE.
BUY MY GENIUS.
[BUY NOW](#)

TIRED OF
BEING ORDINARY?
[UPGRADE NOW](#)

VILLAINY
MADE EASY.
[LEARN MORE](#)

I DON'T
GET REVIEWS.
I GET
WORSHIP.

HEY LOSER :)
YOU'RE IRRELEVANT
[OK](#)

BECOME
UNFORGETTABLE.
[CLICK HERE](#)

WHY BE GOOD
WHEN YOU CAN BE
GODLIKE?
[FIND OUT NOW](#)

ATTENTION:
NOBODY CARES.
[LOL](#)

YOU SUCK.
[DEAL WITH IT](#)

LET THE
WORLD KNOW...

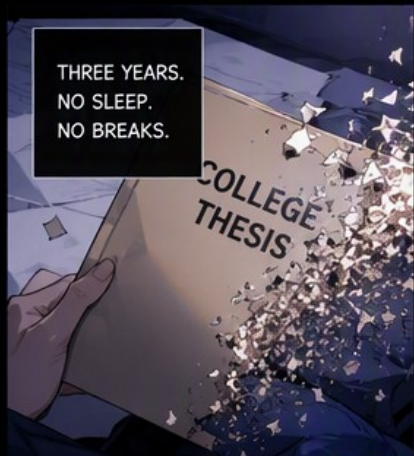
TIME TO
WEAPONIZE
PERCEPTION.

BEEP.

WHIRRRRR

WHO
THE REAL
VILLAIN
IS.





FAULT LINE PROTOCOL

// EPISODE 07: LAST-MILE COLLAPSE



LIVORNO
COURIER SERVICES

LOGIN: DAEMON_17
ROLE: DRONE PILOT
STATUS: OVERDUE
SLEEP: 3.2 HRS
CAFFEINE: 94%

ALL DRONES,
RETURN TO ROUTE.
THIS IS AN ORDER.



REROUTING
FAILED!
SIGNAL
CORRUPTED!

DRONE C-409

LOST

SIGNAL FAILURE



C-409

LOST



C-612

LOST



C-317

LOST



C-503

LOST



C-221

LOST



NO...!
DON'T
LOSE
ANOTHER
ONE!

COME ON!
HOLD THE
LINE!
HOLD THE
LINE!!

SYSTEM ALERT
VORTEX INSTABILITY
98.7%
CONTAINMENT FAILURE
IMMINENT



I CAN'T
LET THEM
DOWN...!



ACTIVE DELIVERIES
87
PENDING
224

NOTE TO SELF:
SLEEP IS
A FEATURE,
NOT A
BUG.

NORTH SECTOR
DISTORTION SPIKE
DETECTED



I'LL
FIX THIS.
I ALWAYS
DO.

MEET KAI

DRONE PILOT EXTRAORDINAIRE

When it comes to
keeping deliveries on track,
Kai's batting 0 against Nano.







ANOTHER NIGHT.
ANOTHER DEAD
END.
JUST HOW I
LIKE IT.

KZZZZT—



WHOA—!

---?!

W-WHERE
AM I?!

NO...!
THIS IS—

NGH...!
WHAT JUST
HAPPENED?!

GLITCH...?
NO, THAT WASN'T
JUST A GLITCH.

SOMETHING
OUT THERE
JUST TOUCHED
SOMETHING
IN HERE.

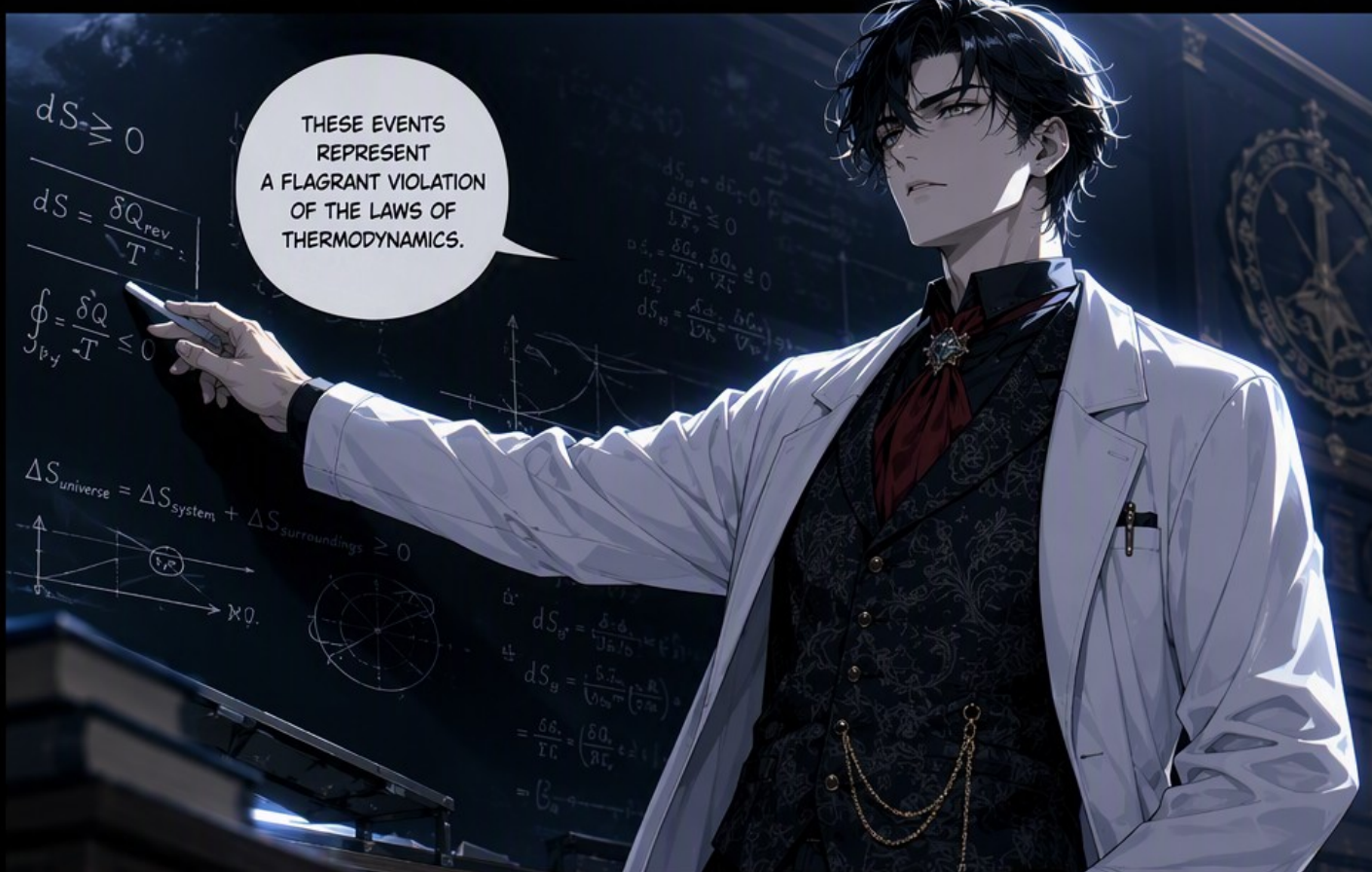
...AND I DON'T
LIKE NOT
KNOWING WHY.



AAAH!

THE EQUATIONS-
THEY'RE REWRITING
THEMSELVES!

WHAT IS
HAPPENING?!
THEMSELVES!



THESE EVENTS
REPRESENT
A FLAGRANT VIOLATION
OF THE LAWS OF
THERMODYNAMICS.

$$dS \geq 0$$

$$dS = \frac{\delta Q_{rev}}{T}$$

$$\oint_{\beta \gamma} \frac{\delta Q}{T} \leq 0$$

$$\Delta S_{universe} = \Delta S_{system} + \Delta S_{surroundings} \geq 0$$



$$dS_g = \frac{\delta Q}{T} = \frac{\delta Q}{T} = \frac{\delta Q}{T}$$
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SPONTANEOUS
FORMATION OF
ORDER. NEGATIVE
ENTROPY.
IMPOSSIBLE.

AND YET...



...THERE IT IS.

THE UNIVERSE
HAS APPARENTLY
DECIDED TO
CHEAT.



B-BUT...

HOW-?!



EXACTLY.

THAT IS
THE PROBLEM.

TARGET:
REALITY GLITCH SIGNATURE
CLASS: UNKNOWN
THREAT: HIGH

...FASCINATING.

REALITY IS
OVER-RATED

BUY THE UPGRADE.

YES

ONLY

\$999.99
/MONTH

YOUR LIFE
IS BORING.
FIX IT.
NOW.

CLICK HERE

REALITY
GLITCH
SIGNATURE...

SO THAT'S
WHAT HE'S
DOING.

ANTENNA
HOOP,
LOCKED.

WHIRR

ROTATION
VECTOR...

BLIND SPOT...
RIGHT THERE.

MARKED.

PING

HE'S
PAINTING
THE WORLD
LIKE A
CANVAS.

HEH. CUTE.
WATCHING
LITTLE MICE
WATCH ME.

BECAUSE I
DON'T JUST
BREAK REALITY—

I SELL THE
PIECES.

...AND
THE BRUSH
IS BROKEN.

DO YOU
THINK YOU
CAN SEE
WHAT I CAN?
ADORABLE.

MAYBE.
BUT I DON'T
NEED TO SEE
EVERYTHING.

I JUST NEED
TO KNOW
WHERE TO
LOOK.



As you can see, he weaponizes information, illusion, and commercial saturation—

—to—
corru—pt pe—
percep—

▲ ERROR
SIGNAL LOSS



Perception is just another product.

And I'm infinite supply.



Ah! My apologies for that brief interruption.

Let us continue, shall we? ♡

✓ SIGNAL RESTORED



Observe how our hero's resistance only strengthens his theatricality.

A timeless pattern in human history.



SECTOR
7B

SERVER FARM

ACCESS RESTRICTED TO
AUTHORIZED PERSONNEL ONLY

VIOLATORS WILL BE
PROSECUTED

立入禁止

許可された人だけ

SECURITY

SECURITY
7B-02

SEC-02

7B SERVER FARM

RELIABILITY.
REDUNDANCY.
RESTRAINT.

SOME PEOPLE
RUN TOWARDS
THE FIRE.

I GET PAID
TO STAND
BESIDE IT.

NEXUS CORE
BREACHED

NO GODS
NO MASTERS

THIS ISN'T
MY CITY.

THIS IS MY
POST.

RESTRICTED ACCESS
CLEARANCE TIER 7
BIOMETRIC GATE



VIOLATION IS A
TERMINABLE OFFENSE

THEY WANT
SOMEONE
TO BLAME.

I OFFER
A WALL.

LET THEM
THROW.

LET THEM
BREAK.

I DON'T NEED
TO UNDERSTAND
THE CHAOS.

I JUST NEED
TO CONTAIN IT.

DISCIPLINE
ISN'T ABOUT
FEELING.

IT'S ABOUT
NOT MOVING.

EVEN WHEN
THE WORLD
GLITCHES...

...THE GATE
STAYS LOCKED.

7B DOESN'T
FALL.

7B ENDURES.



CLEARANCE LEVEL 7



SECTOR 7B SECURITY PROTOCOL
STAND. OBSERVE. CONTAIN.



HAHA!
TAKE THAT,
SUCKER! HOW'D
YOU LIKE THAT
COMBO?!



YESSS!
HEADSHOT!
CRITICAL HIT!



NEW GAME
PLUS MODE
ACTUALLY
HITS DIFFERENT.
10/10



BEST.
GAME.
EVER.



COME ON!
COME ON!
ONE MORE
WAVE!
I CAN
DO THIS
ALL DAY!



WHO KNEW
THE FUTURE OF
GAMING WOULD BE
THIS REAL?

THIS ISN'T
JUST A GAME...
IT'S AN
EXPERIENCE.



I'VE GOT YOU!

FOCUS.
BREATHE.
SCIENCE
DOESN'T FLINCH.



THE CEILING—
IT'S BREAKING
APART?!



LEVERAGE.
DISTRIBUTE
THE LOAD.
KEEP THE
CENTER.

$$M = F \times d$$
$$\tau = r \times F$$
$$\sum_{n,d} F = ma$$
$$\sigma = \frac{F}{A} \leq \sigma_{max}$$



I WONDER
WHAT YOU
LOOKED LIKE...

...WHEN YOU
ROAMED THIS
WORLD.



I WON'T LET
YOU FALL
TODAY.

NOT ON
MY WATCH.

HERE... WE...
GO...!



THE INDIE DEV'S
LAST STAND.

BEG.

DR. DELETE
REALITY GLITCH ENGINEER

APP GOD
REVIEW TYRANT
5-STAR OR ELSE

CURRENT WEAPON:
BAD REVIEWS



P-PLEASE...
DR. DELETE...

SPARE MY
STUDIO...!

JUST ONE
5-STAR REVIEW...
I SWEAR I'LL
KEEP MAKING
GAMES YOU'LL
ACTUALLY LIKE...!

INDIE
DEVELOPER



I'LL FIX THE BUGS...
ADD MORE CONTENT...
NO MICROTRANSACTIONS...
I'LL DO ANYTHING...!

PLEASE...
JUST ONE
5-STAR
REVIEW...!



HMM...

HOW ADORABLE.

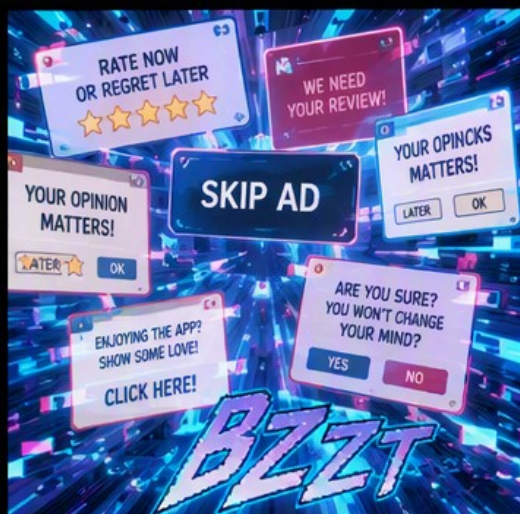
A CREATOR,
GROVELING FOR
VALIDATION.

LET'S SEE IF
YOU'RE WORTHY
OF MERCY.



POP-UP
CANNON.

REALITY
GLITCH
ACTIVATED.



RATE NOW
OR REGRET LATER
★★★★★

WE NEED
YOUR REVIEW!

YOUR OPINION
MATTERS!

SKIP AD

YOUR OPINKS
MATTERS!

ENJOYING THE APP?
SHOW SOME LOVE!

CLICK HERE!

ARE YOU SURE?
YOU WON'T CHANGE
YOUR MIND?

YES

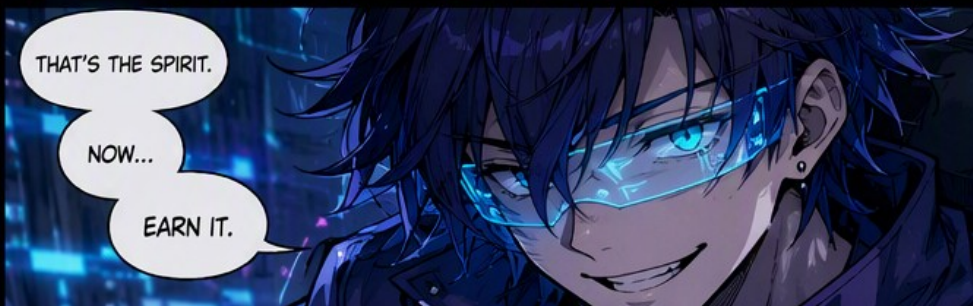
NO

BZZT



NNNGH...!
STOP...!

I'LL GIVE YOU
A 5-STAR...!
JUST PLEASE
STOP...!



THAT'S THE SPIRIT.

NOW...

EARN IT.

MISSION:
EARN A
5-STAR REVIEW

AEGIS VANGUARD // HARBOR-9
EQUIPMENT BAY
23:42



JUST
BORROWING THIS
REAL QUICK!

PROMISE I'LL
BRING IT RIGHT
BACK! ☆

YOU'VE GOT
TO BE KIDDING
ME.



I'LL ONLY
BE TWO
MINUTES!

SCOUT'S
HONOR!
☆

TWO MINUTES
TURN INTO TWO
HOURS WITH
YOU.

...FINE.
BUT DON'T SAY
I DIDN'T WARN
YOU.



THANKS,
SERA!
☆

TAP
TAP
TAP!

SHE'LL BE BACK.
PROBABLY.
...I HOPE.



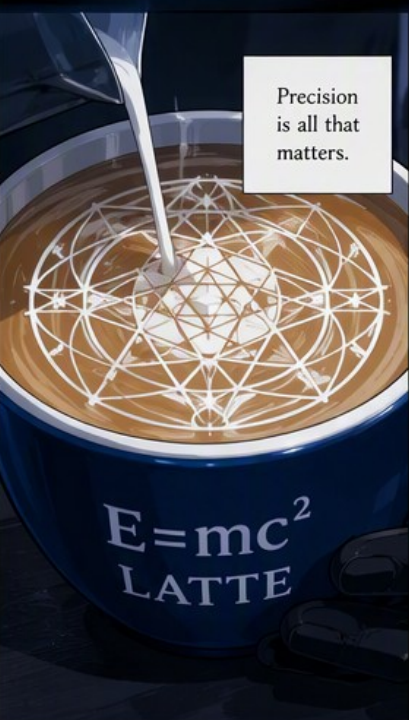
$E=MC^2$ LATTE

Quantum café scientist:
Where every equation
brews possibility.

☕ QUANTUM MENU

- Heisenberg Uncertainty Mocha
- Schrödinger's Catpuccino
- Dirac Delta Espresso
- Planck's Constant Cocoa
- Quantum Entanglement Latte

Today's Special:
Wave Function Foam



$$E=mc^2$$

$$\frac{d}{dx} \langle \hat{A} \rangle = \frac{\nabla^2}{2}$$

$$|\hat{\psi}\rangle = \alpha|0\rangle + \beta|1\rangle$$

$$i\hbar \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \Psi(\vec{r}, t) =$$

$$= \hat{H} \Psi(\vec{r}, t)$$

$$\nabla^2 \psi + \frac{2m}{\hbar^2} (E - V) \psi = 0$$

$$\Delta x \Delta p \geq \frac{\hbar}{2}$$

$$= \oint \vec{B} \cdot d\vec{l} = \mu_0 I$$

$$\Phi = \oint \vec{E} \cdot d\vec{A}$$

QUANTUM CAFÉ

SUPERPOSITION LATTE	7.77
ESPRESSO	3.14
AMERICANO	3.14
QUANTUM BITTER	4.20
ENTANGLEMENT MOCHA	6.28
HAZELIINO DE BROGLIE	5.55
CAPPUCCINO	4.44
SCHRÖDINGER'S CATPUCCINO	6.66



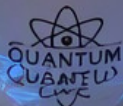
$E=mc^2$
LATTE

TODAY'S SPECIAL:
PLANCK CONSTANT LATTE

$$E = h\nu$$



$$h = 6.62607015 \times 10^{-34} \text{ J}\cdot\text{s}$$



QUANTUM
CAFÉ





VWAZ

LOOKS LIKE SOMEONE'S STILL LIVING IN TRIAL MODE.

LET ME UPGRADE YOUR WORLD.



EVERYTHING IS FOR SALE.

EVEN YOU.

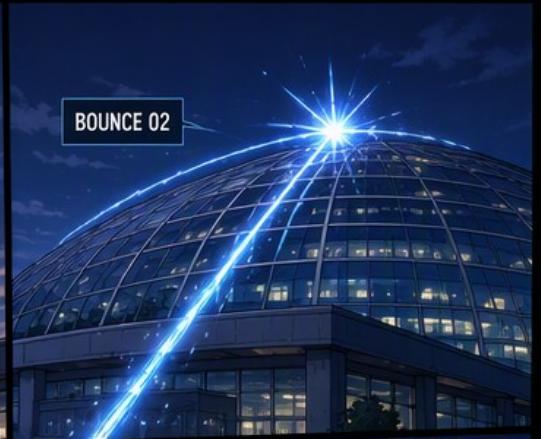




RELAY DISH
ALIGN. LOCK.
TRANSMIT.



BOUNCE 01



BOUNCE 02



BOUNCE 03



SIGNAL TRACE
PATH OPTIMIZED.
LATENCY MINIMAL.
TARGET LOCKED.



OH?

SOMEONE'S
SENDING LOVE
ACROSS CAMPUS?



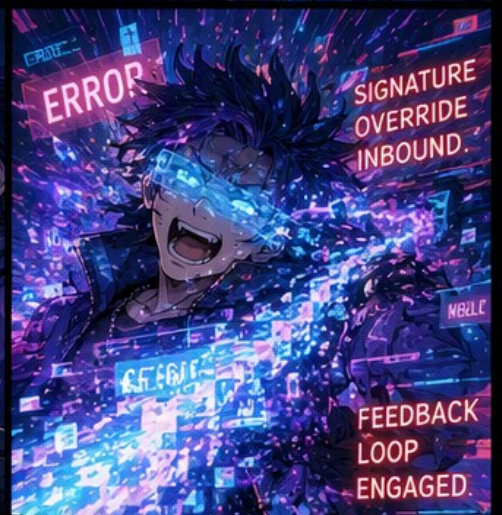
OVERLOAD
HIS OWN
GLITCH SIGNATURE—
FEED IT BACK
TO HIM!



INVERT. AMPLIFY.
REVERSE.
RETURN.



?!
ERROR



ERROR

SIGNATURE
OVERRIDE
INBOUND.

FEEDBACK
LOOP
ENGAGED.



GHAAH—!

IMPOSSIBLE!

HAHAHAHA!

BEHOLD!

I DON'T JUST
BREAK RULES—
I REWRITE REALITY
TO MY LIKING!

THIS CAMPUS?
MINE!

EVERY SCREEN
IS MY STAGE!

EVERY MIND,
MY AUDIENCE!

CONGRATULATIONS!
YOU WIN!
FREE TUITION
FOR A SEMESTER!
CLAIM NOW

ATTENTION STUDENTS!
MANDATORY UPDATE
REQUIRED
UPDATE

KNEEL
BEFORE THE
ARCHITECT OF
TOMORROW!

I AM
SUPREME!

I AM
INEVITABLE!

W-WHAT?!

NO... THIS
CAN'T BE—!

SYSTEM
OVERRIDE:
REALITY ACCESS
GRANTED.



ECHO RIDGE ACADEMY
CENTER PLAZA

THE LABORATORY WING
WASN'T DESTROYED.

IT WAS DISSOLVED.

SUBATOMICALLY
UNPACKED.

INFORMATION
MADE MANIFEST.

NOW IT REMEMBERS
ITSELF BACK TOGETHER.

